

GLOBAL RISK SERVICES

WORKERS' COMPENSATION RISK ASSESSMENT REPORT

Account Name:	Summit Foundry & Forge	Survey Date:	2026-04-12
Policy Number:	WC-77291-2026	Surveyor Name:	Marcus Vance, CSP
Insured Address:		Industry Segment:	

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Summit Foundry & Forge represents an extremely high-risk operation with severe, unmitigated hazard exposures. The plant floor exhibits poor housekeeping, widespread fluid leaks, and a systemic failure to enforce basic safety protocols. Critical safety devices, such as machine guards and lockout/tagout systems, are either absent or bypassed. Multiple hazard categories, including lifting, laceration control, machine guarding, and crane rigging, are evaluated as Inadequate. Immediate corrective action is required to bring this facility into basic compliance.

DETAILED FIELD OBSERVATIONS & RISK EVALUATION

1. Lifting (Industrial Ergonomics) — **INADEQUATE**

Hazard Context: Industrial ergonomics and lifting hazards related to handling heavy sheet metal raw stocks and dies.

Field Observations: The plant relies almost entirely on manual lifting for casting parts. Workers were observed repeatedly lifting 55-65 lb castings from cooling beds into metal sorting bins. There are no vacuum assists or hydraulic tables in this section. This lack of controls directly matches their claims history, which shows four active lower-back strain claims since 2024.

Risk Control Recommendation: Mandate the installation of crane hoists or pneumatic vacuum assist manipulators in the casting cooling and sorting areas. Forbid manual lifting of materials exceeding 40 pounds.

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2. Lacerations / Cut Safety — **INADEQUATE**

Hazard Context: Control of puncture and cut injuries stemming from raw sheet metal handling and grinding operations.

Field Observations: Widespread laceration hazards exist. Sharp metal flash and slag are trimmed by hand with minimal personal protective equipment. The surveyor observed workers in the stamping bay utilizing thin, cotton-knit string gloves with no cut rating. Management does not provide cut-resistant sleeves or require Level A5 gloves.

Risk Control Recommendation: Enact an immediate, zero-tolerance policy requiring Level A5 cut-resistant gloves and protective Kevlar arm sleeves for all employees handling raw metal parts, sheared plates, or slag trims.

3. Material Loading / Unloading & Securement — **LIMITED/INCONSISTENT**

Hazard Context: Forklift and heavy machinery operations involving loading flatbeds and storage yard logistics.

Field Observations: The loading dock area has no designated forklift safety lanes, leading to chaotic traffic flows. Flatbed trailer loading docks do not use safety gates or wheel chocks. Flatbed tie-down straps were stored on the floor, and several wire ropes showed severe crushing and broken strands.

Risk Control Recommendation: Paint forklift safety boundaries on the loading floor. Require all trailers to be mechanically wheel-chocked prior to forklift entry. Discard crushed wire loading ropes immediately.

4. Overhead Lifting Equipment — **INADEQUATE**

Hazard Context: Use and structural integrity of overhead cranes, hoists, rigging slings, and crane hooks.

Field Observations: Two overhead hoists in the smelting bay had crane hooks with completely missing or broken safety latches, exposing loads to accidental slipping. Rigging slings were scattered in dirty heaps. The surveyor inspected three wire rope slings in use and discovered broken strands exceeding OSHA safety limits. No daily inspection checklists have been maintained since mid-2025.

Risk Control Recommendation: Immediately replace all broken crane hook safety latches. Remove all damaged wire slings from service. Establish a daily inspection checklist and assign a designated crane safety supervisor. CNA RISK CONTROL SERVICES WORKERS' COMPENSATION FIELD REPORT

5. Machine Guarding & Electrical Safety — **INADEQUATE**

Hazard Context: Physical point-of-operation machinery guards and electrical Lockout/Tagout procedures.

Field Observations: Severe machine guarding failures were noted. The mechanical guard on the main plate-shearing machine had been completely unscrewed and set aside. Safety interlocks on the CNC milling machine doors had been electrically bypassed with wire jumpers. LOTO locks and keys were dusty and kept inside a locked supervisor drawer with no active log, indicating they are rarely used.

Risk Control Recommendation: Immediately shut down the bypassed CNC milling machines and shearing units. Re-install all factory guard structures and remove electrical bypass jumpers. Conduct an emergency, all-hands retraining session on Lockout/Tagout protocols.

6. Occupational Disease & Illness — **LIMITED/INCONSISTENT**

Hazard Context: Control of employee exposure to noise, toxic fumes from welding, and hexavalent chromium.

Field Observations: While welding masks are standard, the main ventilation blower was inoperable during the site visit, causing visible weld fume accumulation in the rafters. Grinding dust was heavy, covering light fixtures and surfaces. Noise levels were extremely high, but several workers were wearing earplugs hanging around their necks rather than properly in their ears.

Risk Control Recommendation: Repair the welding exhaust ventilation blower immediately. Implement strict supervisor enforcement of hearing protection device usage on the floor.

7. Walking / Working Surfaces — **INADEQUATE**

Hazard Context: Housekeeping, fluid leaks, slip-and-fall hazards, and floor maintenance.

Field Observations: Widespread coolant and hydraulic fluid leaks are present on the concrete floor, with no absorbents applied. Walkways are cluttered with raw stock off-cuts and metal shavings. The surveyor observed two slip hazards in the main pedestrian aisle. Housekeeping is virtually non-existent on the second shift.

Risk Control Recommendation: Establish a mandatory end-of-shift housekeeping protocol for both shifts. Repair hydraulic oil leaks on all stamping machinery and apply oil-absorbent compounds immediately. CNA

8. Elevated Work Surfaces — **NOT ENOUGH INFO**

Hazard Context: Stairs, platforms, fall arrest harnesses, and elevated mezzanine structures.

Field Observations: The facility maintains an elevated parts-storage platform located 12 feet above the smelting deck. The surveyor requested access to inspect the stairs and perimeter guardrails, but access was denied by the plant manager due to unsafe chemical fumes in that specific sector during the visit.

Risk Control Recommendation: Ensure safe, ventilated access is provided for a follow-up risk control inspection of the storage platform and its corresponding perimeter safety systems.